



**Above** The canal-side restaurants of La Petite France allow diners to sample authentic Alsatian food in a time-honored setting

**Left** The Gothic towers of Strasbourg Cathedral form a stunning backdrop to the Christmas market, held here since 1570



**Above** Choucroute garnie is nostalgia on a plate for many Alsatis, evoking precious memories of childhood and home



### What Else to Eat

Centuries of shifting borders between Germany and France have imbued the city and its cuisine with a unique style. Try **baeckeoffe**, a hearty stew of potatoes, pork, beef, lamb, and white wine, which is always on the menu at **Le Baeckeoffe d'Alsace** ([www.baeckeoffe.com](http://www.baeckeoffe.com)).

**Fleischschneke**, minced beef rolled in noodle dough, then sliced and cooked in a meaty broth, is good at **Le Clou** (see right). For a quick snack, grab a **bretzel** (pretzel) from any bakery – they've been cooking them here since the 14th century. If you prefer something sweeter, try a **kougelhoppf**, a brioche studded with raisins.

## The Best Places to Eat Choucroute Garnie

### Chez Yvonne inexpensive

Chez Yvonne is something of an institution in Strasbourg. Sandwiched between 16th-century timber-fronted houses in a street just a step or two from the mighty cathedral, this woody *winstub* oozes old Strasbourg. Rustic and down-to-earth, it has a menu that includes all of Alsace's tried and tested, true and timeless dishes: goose foie gras, *presskopt*, *coq au Riesling*, *jambonneau*, and, of course, *choucroute garnie*. *Winstub* cooking is, above all, familial, and Alsatian families tend to have a favorite one that they like to call their own. Chez Yvonne is that kind of place. *Winstub* translates as "wine room," and the room (*stube*) refers to a cozy one in someone's house where everyone relaxes. Yvonne herself may have retired long ago, but the *kelsch* (gingham) curtains, warm wood paneling, and pottery live on, along with the generous plate of *choucroute garnie*, a happy confluence of pork liver quenelles, pork knuckle, blood sausage, Strasbourg and Monbéliard sausages, salted pork loin, smoked pork belly, and fermented cabbage. It's perfect with the restaurant's dry white Sylvaner wine.

**10 rue du Sanglier, Strasbourg; noon–2:15 PM & 6 PM–midnight daily; [www.chez-yvonne.net](http://www.chez-yvonne.net)**

### Also in Strasbourg

Captivating **Le Clou** ([www.le-clou.com](http://www.le-clou.com); *inexpensive*) is everything you could wish for in a *winstub*: welcoming, warm, woody, and full of delicious smells. Tables are shared, so you'll be rubbing shoulders with strangers, but somehow that doesn't seem inappropriate when you're eating this kind of food. People dream of the consommé with bone-marrow quenelles and the *choucroute royale avec wädle*, a regal version of *choucroute garnie* that substitutes champagne for wine and adds a hefty pork knuckle to the meat contingent.

### Also in France

**Drouant** ([www.drouant.com](http://www.drouant.com); *expensive*) in Paris started out as a humble tobacco-bar in 1880, but today it's a first-class restaurant owned by three-star Michelin chef and Alsatian Antoine Westermann. Its founder Charles Drouant also hailed from Alsace, and his former customers included the artists Renoir, Rodin, and Pissarro. Westermann champions French products and traditions and has a particular penchant for his childhood home of Alsace. Come winter, *choucroute* pops up on the menu.

### Around the World

The *choucroute Alsacienne* at **Brasserie Jo** ([www.brasseriejo.com](http://www.brasseriejo.com); *moderate*) in Boston, MA, is the real thing; founder and owner Jean Joho hails from Alsace and cooked for many years in Strasbourg and the award-winning Auberge d'Ill before decamping to Boston.